# SENSay for teachers and SENCOs

## Every pupil heard, every target evidenced, every review on time

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|---|---|
| **Guide** | SENSay for teachers and SENCOs |
| **Date** | 23 Oct 2026 |
| **For** | Special schools, resourced provisions and SEN units |
| **In short** | Pupils get a board they can learn by position. Staff get evidence by target, a Today page that shows who needs them, and review packs built from what pupils actually said, at school and at home |
| **Contact** | hello@sensay.uk |

## 1. What SENSay does for your school

SENSay gives pre-verbal and non-verbal pupils a communication board, and gives staff the evidence behind what those pupils are telling them. Every message a pupil sends is recorded with when, where and what came before it, at school and at home. That record becomes pupil evidence by area of need, progress against targets, and the first draft of a review pack, without anyone writing it up from memory.

It is built for the reality of a special school or resourced provision: several pupils, many adults, little time, and an annual review always coming.

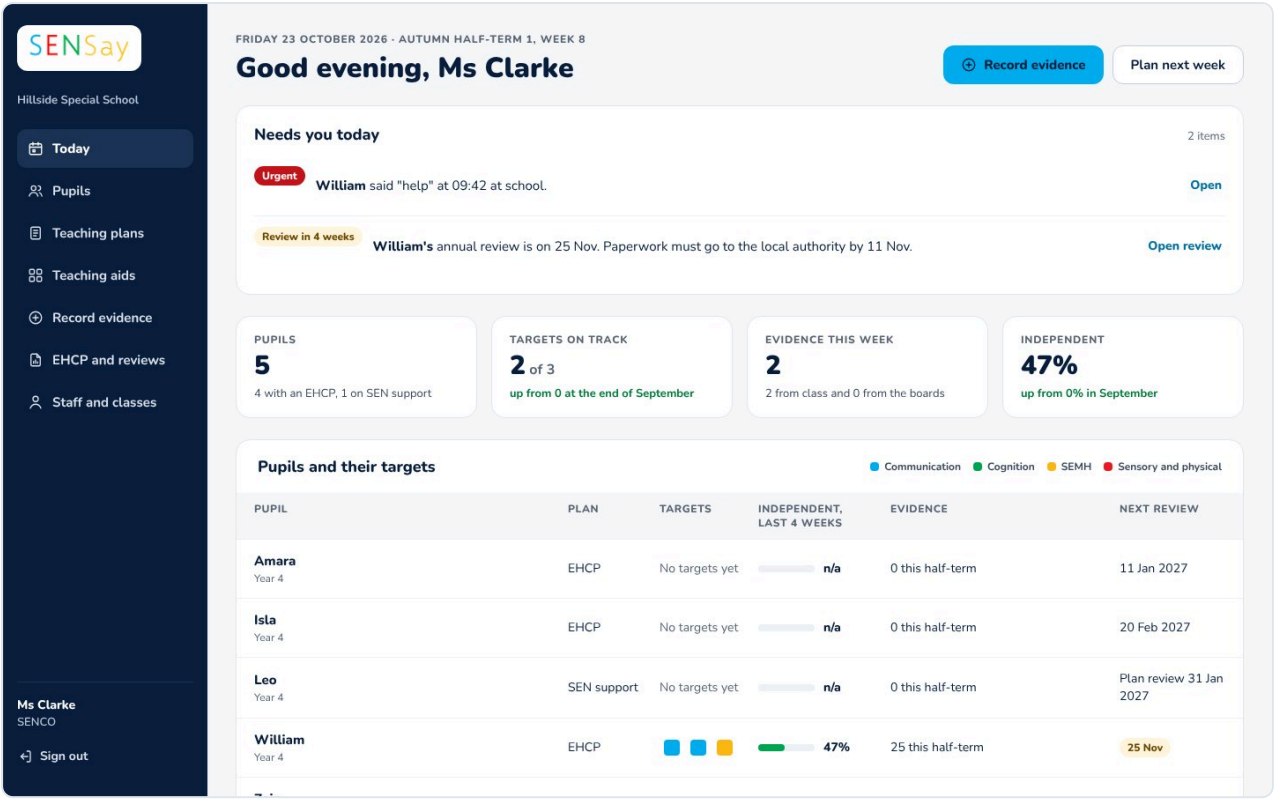
| You need | SENSay gives you |
|---|---|
| A board pupils can actually use | 43 core words in fixed places, 32 word lists, 36 everyday topics, a keyboard and each pupil's own words and photos |
| To know who needs you today | A Today page with urgent messages, reviews coming up and targets short of evidence |
| Evidence for targets | Quick capture in class, with the pupil's own board words filled in for you |
| Review paperwork on time | Countdowns, the pupil's and parent's views, progress and provision gathered into a pack |
| The family on side | Parents see targets and progress, and add their views before reviews |
| Teaching resources | Visual timetables, choice boards, social stories and more, sent to a pupil's device or the class screen |

## 2. Setting up your school

1. **The SENCO signs up** at app.sensay.uk, chooses "I am a teacher" and then **Set up your school**. They become the school's lead.
2. **Invite staff** under Staff and classes. Roles are SENCO, Teacher, Teaching assistant, Senior leader, Therapist and Administrator. Staff accept by signing up with the invited email.

3. **Create classes** and add pupils. Each family generates a one-time link code in their app (it looks like SEN-4F7K2QX9 and lasts 24 hours). Enter it under Pupils, then Add a pupil.
4. **Record each pupil's plan:** SEN support, EHCP or individual support plan, with the next review date.

Linking through the family keeps consent where it belongs. The parent decides to share; the school never holds a pupil the family has not linked.




Today: urgent messages, reviews due and targets needing evidence, with no AI involved

## 3. The board in school

Pupils use the same board at school and at home, so a word learned in class is in the same place at teatime. Staff see each pupil's board read-only from their record (View their board), which speaks but never sends.

- **Core words never move.** 43 of the most-used words sit in fixed places, so pupils learn by position.
- **Six words are always on screen:** yes, no, stop, help, pain and toilet.
- **The setting switch** at the top of the board (Home, School, Therapy) decides who receives messages, so a message sent at school goes to the staff the family has added.
- **Lesson words** appear from the first Topics tile while a lesson is running, and the **word of the week** is outlined wherever it appears.
- **Adult modelling** is a switch above the board. Messages sent while it is on are marked as an adult's, so they never count as the pupil's own words.
- **Restrictions** set by the family, such as allergies and food rules, apply everywhere, including choices you send from school.

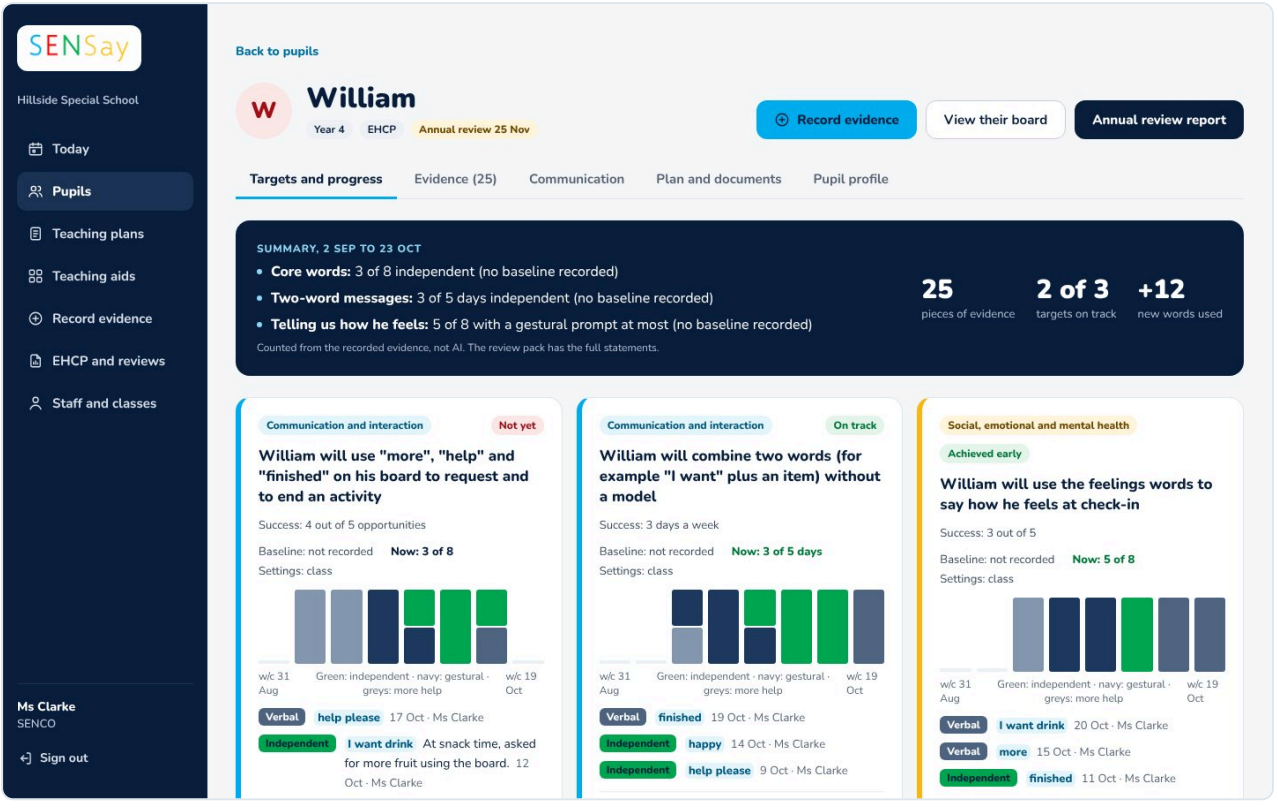
## 4. Today, pupils and the pupil record

**Today** is the first page staff see. It lists what needs attention: urgent board messages from the last 24 hours, reviews coming up, targets without enough evidence, and patterns worth a look. It uses no AI, and adult modelling is left out of every count.

**Pupils** lists every pupil with their class, plan, targets, recent evidence and next review, filtered by class and plan type.

**The pupil record** has five tabs:

| Tab | What it holds |
|---|---|
| Targets and progress | Each target with its measure, success criterion and progress by week, coloured by level of support |
| Evidence | Every observation, with who recorded it, the support given and the words used |
| Communication | What the pupil said this week and this half term: words, feelings, new words and anything worth a look |
| Plan and documents | The pupil's plan and attached documents |
| Pupil profile | What the family has shared: the people who matter, favourites, what helps, and restrictions |




The pupil record: targets with progress by level of support

## 5. Recording evidence

**Record evidence** is a full-screen capture built for use mid-lesson on a tablet or phone.

1. Choose the pupil and the target.
2. Choose how much help they needed, from full physical support through modelled, verbal and gestural to independent.

3. "What they said" is filled in from the pupil's own board messages in the last 15 minutes. Check it and save.

It works without a connection and sends when the signal is back. Photos and files can be attached. In lesson mode, one adult can record for several pupils in turn.

**Quick questions** let you ask one pupil a question with two to eight picture answers: a choice, a check-in, a recognition task or yes and no. The answer and how long it took are recorded as evidence, or not kept if it was practice.

## 6. Reviews and EHCPs

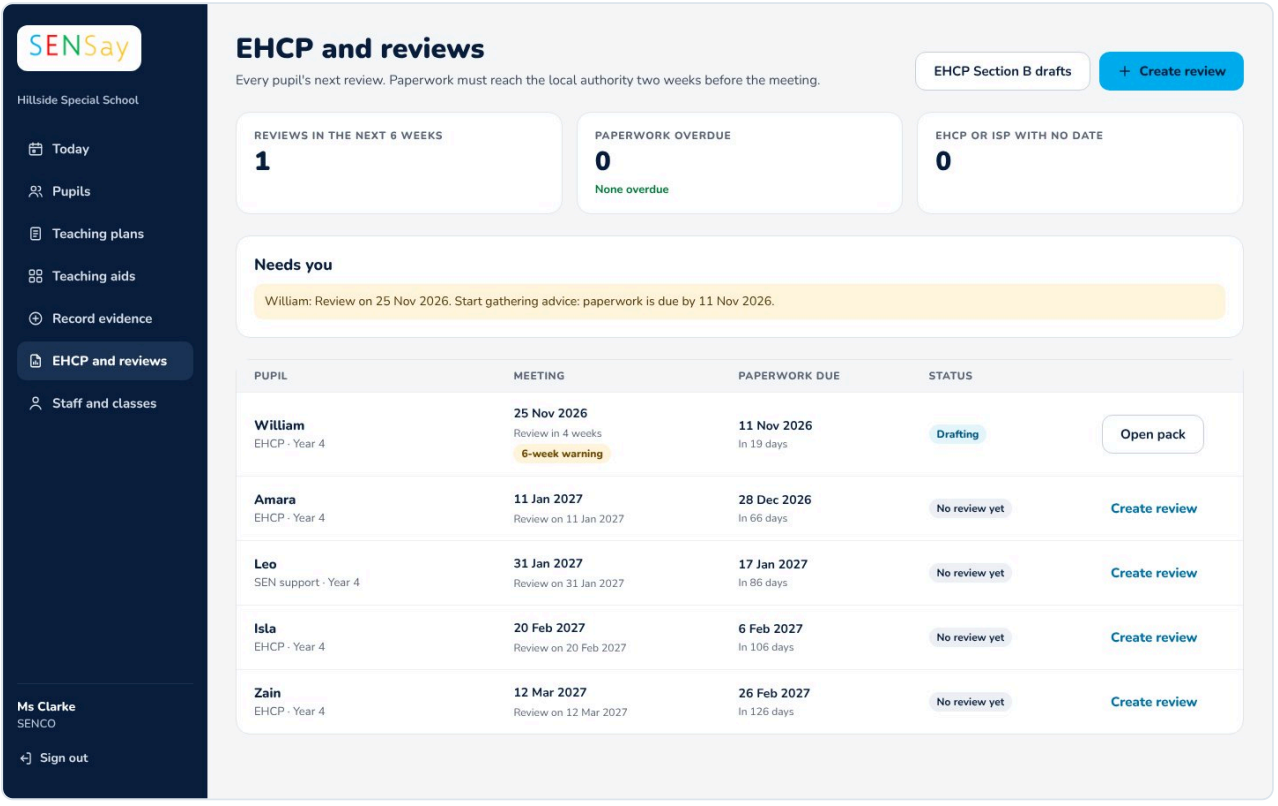
**EHCP and reviews** counts down to each meeting, with warnings at six, four and two weeks, and paperwork due 14 days before the meeting.

Each review builds an **evidence pack**:

- **The pupil's views,** drawn from their own board messages, with a short summary.
- **The parent's views,** written by the family in their app.
- **Progress** against each outcome, from the recorded evidence.
- **Provision** in place.
- **Draft proposals** for the next year, with every number checked against the records.

A pack cannot be marked ready without both the pupil's and the parent's views. It exports as a PDF.

**Section B drafts,** for the school's advice to the local authority, describe the pupil's communication and interaction from the evidence. A draft needs at least eight pieces of evidence, otherwise SENSay says there is not enough yet. Every draft is marked for review and every statement links back to the observation it came from. SENSay provides the first draft; the SENCO provides the judgement.




EHCP and reviews: countdowns, paperwork deadlines and status for every pupil

## 7. Teaching aids and the class screen

**Teaching aids** are made in SENSay from the same symbols as the board:

| Aid | Use |
|---|---|
| Visual timetable | Now and next, shown above the pupil's board |
| First and then | One task, then the reward |
| Choice board | Two to eight choices |
| Lesson board | The words for this lesson |
| Feelings check-in | How are you feeling? |
| Token board | Working towards a reward |
| Social story | A short story for a new or hard situation |
| Sequence and recipe | Steps in order |
| Timer | A visual countdown |
| Communication passport | A one-page profile for new adults, drafted from the records |

Each aid except the passport (print only) can be sent to a pupil's device, to the **class screen** (a whiteboard or iPad showing the class's aids and words of the week), or printed.

**Teaching plans** hold class and pupil plans: core words by week, targets, lessons with words to model, and boards to share with pupils. SENSay can suggest a plan from an existing document, which you then check and edit.

## 8. Working with families and therapists

- **Families** see their child's targets, progress and therapy notes under From school, and add their views before reviews. Families receive every message; the staff they add receive messages sent at school.
- **Therapists** see the pupil's record when the family shares it with them. Their session notes, including advice for home and school, appear in the pupil's evidence.
- **Notifications:** urgent messages (pain, feeling ill, needing help, feeling unsafe, the toilet) reach the staff the family has added straight away, by email or text.

## 9. Data protection

- The school is the data controller for the records it creates; SENSay is the processor. We sign a data processing agreement with every school and provide a data protection impact assessment template.
- Data is held in the EU (Ireland), encrypted in transit and at rest.
- Staff see only pupils at their own school. Families decide what is shared.
- Nothing is shared with anyone except the services that run SENSay (our AI, email and text providers), under contract.
- AI is used only where it is labelled: drafts and summaries, always marked as drafts and never shown to the pupil. Nothing is used to train AI models.
- A pupil's data can be removed at any time on request.

## 10. Prices

Every school licence includes unlimited staff, the board for every pupil, evidence, reviews and EHCP drafts, teaching aids, and the family app free for each pupil's family. Prices are a year, plus VAT, invoiced annually in advance.

| Licence | Pupils | A year |
|---|---|---|
| Starter | Up to 5 | £895 |
| Standard | Up to 15 | £1,495 |
| Large | Up to 30 | £2,295 |
| Special school | Up to 80, then £45 each | £4,495 |

Multi-academy trusts save 5% at two or three schools, 10% at four to nine and 15% at ten or more. Every price is under £10,000, which most schools can buy with a quote and a purchase order.

**Pupils on other devices.** If some pupils use TD Snap, Grid 3 or another device, SENSay Connect brings their usage into the same records. It is included in Large and Special school licences and is £395 a year for Starter and Standard.

**Founding schools.** We are working with a small group of founding schools in 2026 to 2027, with a direct line into the product team and prices locked for three years. Ask us about it.

## 11. Getting started

- [ ] SENCO signs up and sets up the school
- [ ] Data processing agreement signed
- [ ] Staff invited and classes created
- [ ] Families send link codes; pupils added with their plan and review date
- [ ] Targets entered for each pupil
- [ ] One week of evidence recorded before the first review

Questions, a demo or a quote: hello@sensay.uk